



## Save drafts on Instagram

Six years after its launch, Instagram has finally rolled out a 'save as draft' feature for all users.  
<http://dgit.in/InstaDraft>



## The 'smart candle'

So candles can't be smart? Here's a candle that can be controlled with your smartphone.  
<http://dgit.in/SmrtCndl>

Work@tech

create a comprehensive advertising plan for a particular campaign. It enables more targeted advertising, which ensures that users are able to view ads that are most relevant to them. For advertisers, there is greater visibility on their return on investment, thus helping fuel future decisions with respect to marketing spend. It is famously said that we have moved from an era of 'mad men' (referring to the famous American drama series) to 'math men', and rightly so. The new digital marketing landscape is being driven by a growth of programmatic advertising, where data is the foundation of performance-driven marketing."

## Tools and their courses

While personal talents are essential to make it into the data science industry, a strong academic know-how is important as well. According to a study by Burtch Works (<http://dgit.in/BWDataAnalyst>), almost 88% of data scientists at least have a Masters Degree and 46% even have a Ph.D. That being said, companies are desperately on the lookout for candidates with real world experience that can complement and even surpass the academical proficiency needed for the roles.

Just like most fields now, if you don't have the capacity or the time to accomplish a graduate or postgraduate certification in data sciences, you can go the self guided way with MOOCs. As Mr. Sunil puts it, "Python and R should definitely be part of the toolkit. An important point to note is that depending solely on tools cannot help in developing the vital technical skills required in a data scientist. Understanding the underpinnings (mainly mathematics) of the techniques used is very important."

While developing the understanding is up to you, the following link talks about the essential technical and non-technical skills that you will need and some of the best online sources to learn: <http://dgit.in/DataScienceTools>.

## Going Big

When things are at the scale of the web, normal data analysis will prob-



**MR. SUNIL NANDIHALLI**  
HEAD OF DATA SCIENCE AT  
APPLIFT.

“There are a lot of opportunities to leverage data to improve business efficiencies and we have just scratched the surface of the huge realm of possibilities out there.”

ably not work and it has to be taken up a notch with more powerful tools. In fact, most data scientists work with distributed loads that cannot be run on single machines. And the keyword for that is Hadoop.

Hadoop is an open-source framework widely used for storage and large scale processing of data sets on clusters of commodity hardware. Two of its essential features are MapReduce and Spark. While MapReduce is the programming paradigm that allows for massive scalability across servers in a Hadoop cluster, Apache Spark is more like Hadoop's Swiss Army knife. It is a fast running data analysis system that provides real-time data processing functions to Hadoop. While there are online resources available to learn this platform, true proficiency in this can only come through experience. Thankfully, this is open-source and there are a lot of community resources available to get you started. (Spark: <http://dgit.in/DataScienceSprkHadoop>)

Kaggle is an online community dedicated to data science. It hosts competitions and leaderboards for data science problem solving regularly. You can even run your code on the cloud and get community feedback on it. Mr. Sunil says, "Kaggle is an interesting website where one can solve problems (and learn whatever necessary along the way) to become proficient data scientists." Other than that, it is always productive to have your own pet project as well. Go to <https://www.quandl.com/> for data.

## Certifications

Some of the most useful certifications in Data Science are:

- Certified Analytics Professional at <https://www.certifiedanalytics.org/>
- CCP: Data Scientist at <http://dgit.in/CCPDSCloudera>
- EMC: Data Science Associate at <http://dgit.in/DataScientistEMC>
- SAS Certified Predictive Modeler at <http://dgit.in/SASGblCrftct>

## In Conclusion

Being a data scientist might sound like a very cool job (which it definitely is), after all, the information given earlier. But right now, the conclusion is to be drawn by you, not us – one of the many conclusions to come. "Data Science is as much art as it is science," Mr. Arun rightly states. With decisions being automated everyday, a specialisation within Data Science is very essential for long term job security. Being curious and creative in the scientific context are as much of a necessity here as the technical skills mentioned earlier, to stay relevant in your role.

Also, remember that your conclusions will affect how major decisions are taken and will need to be understood by people with little to no technical knowledge. You need to be effective at working with a team and have great communication skills. Who knows, being a storyteller might be much more useful than all that mathematical and programming knowledge. After all, you're the one who'll be writing your own success story here! 📌